



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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EQUAL OPPORTUNITY, SC/ST WELFARE, MINORITY SUPPORT & INCLUSIVE EDUCATION POLICY

(Including Equal Opportunity Cell – EOC)

Preamble

St. Ann's College for Women is committed to promoting equality, inclusiveness, social justice, and empowerment of all students irrespective of caste, creed, religion, language, community, economic background, disability, or social status.

The institution believes in creating a learner-centered, discrimination-free, and inclusive educational environment that ensures equal opportunities for students belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Minorities, Other Backward Classes (OBC), economically weaker sections, and differently-abled students.

This policy is framed in accordance with the guidelines of the University Grants Commission (UGC), National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), Government of Andhra Pradesh, and the constitutional principles of equality and social justice.

Objectives of the Policy

The objectives of this policy are to:

- Promote equal access and opportunities in higher education for all students.
- Ensure an inclusive, safe, and discrimination-free campus environment.
- Support the educational, social, emotional, and economic needs of SC/ST, minority, and disadvantaged students.
- Prevent discrimination, harassment, exclusion, and social inequality.
- Encourage participation of marginalized students in academic, co-curricular, leadership, and extension activities.
- Facilitate awareness about scholarships, welfare schemes, and government support programs.
- Provide academic guidance, mentoring, counselling, and career support.
- Promote constitutional values of equality, dignity, secularism, and social harmony.

Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC)

Purpose of the EOC

The Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC) is established to ensure equal access, inclusion, and support for students belonging to disadvantaged and marginalized sections of society.

The EOC works to safeguard the rights and interests of students and staff and to create awareness regarding equality and social justice.

Functions of the Equal Opportunity Cell

The EOC shall:

- Promote equality and inclusiveness on campus.
- Ensure non-discrimination on the basis of caste, religion, gender, disability, language, or socio-economic status.
- Address grievances related to discrimination and exclusion.
- Assist students in availing scholarships, fee concessions, and welfare schemes.
- Organize awareness programs, seminars, workshops, and counselling sessions.
- Coordinate support services for disadvantaged students.
- Promote inclusive participation in academic and extracurricular activities.
- Monitor implementation of inclusive education practices in the institution.

SC/ST Welfare Policy

The institution is committed to the welfare and empowerment of students belonging to Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

Support Measures

The college shall:

- Provide equal opportunities in admissions and participation.
- Disseminate information regarding scholarships, fee reimbursement, and government welfare schemes.
- Offer mentoring, remedial coaching, and academic support.
- Encourage participation in seminars, skill development, and career guidance programs.
- Promote awareness regarding constitutional rights and social empowerment.
- Address grievances relating to discrimination or social injustice promptly and confidentially.

SC/ST Welfare Cell

The SC/ST Welfare Cell shall function to:

- Support the academic and personal development of SC/ST students.
- Facilitate access to scholarships and financial assistance.
- Maintain records related to welfare measures.
- Coordinate with government agencies regarding welfare schemes.
- Organize motivational and awareness programs.

Minority Welfare & Support Policy

The institution values cultural diversity and promotes inclusive participation of minority students in all academic and institutional activities.

Objectives

- To ensure equal educational opportunities for minority students.
- To create a harmonious and secular campus environment.
- To support minority students through guidance and counselling.
- To encourage educational advancement and empowerment.

Support Services

The college shall:

- Provide information on minority scholarships and welfare schemes.
- Offer mentoring and counselling support.
- Encourage participation in academic, cultural, and leadership activities.
- Promote communal harmony, mutual respect, and national integration.

Inclusive Education Policy

The institution adopts inclusive education practices to ensure that all students learn together in a supportive and respectful environment.

Institutional Commitments

The college shall:

- Promote learner-centered and inclusive teaching practices.
- Provide equal access to educational resources and opportunities.
- Encourage participation of all students in classroom and campus activities.

- Support differently-abled and disadvantaged learners through necessary accommodations.
- Ensure a barrier-free and student-friendly learning environment.
- Promote sensitivity, empathy, and respect for diversity.

Anti-Discrimination Measures

The institution strictly prohibits:

- Caste-based discrimination
- Religious discrimination
- Social exclusion
- Harassment or bullying
- Verbal or emotional abuse
- Discriminatory remarks or behavior

Any complaint related to discrimination shall be addressed through the appropriate grievance redressal mechanisms of the institution.

Student Support Services

The college provides the following support services:

- Academic mentoring
- Remedial coaching
- Personal counselling
- Career guidance and placement support
- Scholarship assistance
- Financial aid guidance
- Soft skill and personality development programs
- Awareness programs on rights and welfare schemes

Awareness & Outreach Activities

The institution shall organize:

- Awareness programs on equality and constitutional values
- Seminars on social justice and human rights
- Observance of important national days related to equality and empowerment

- Community outreach and extension activities
- Workshops on inclusiveness and diversity

Responsibilities of Students

Students are expected to:

- Respect diversity and maintain harmony on campus.
- Avoid discriminatory behavior or remarks.
- Cooperate in promoting an inclusive academic environment.
- Follow institutional rules and ethical practices.

Grievance Redressal

Students facing discrimination, exclusion, or inequality may approach:

- Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC)
- SC/ST Welfare Cell
- Minority Welfare Committee
- Grievance Redressal Cell
- Anti-Discrimination Cell
- Principal

All grievances shall be handled confidentially and fairly.

Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed periodically by the College Administration, IQAC, Equal Opportunity Cell, and related committees in accordance with UGC, NAAC, and Government regulations.

Conclusion

St. Ann's College for Women is dedicated to fostering equality, inclusiveness, social justice, and empowerment through equitable educational opportunities and support systems for all students. The institution strives to build a campus culture rooted in dignity, respect, harmony, and holistic development for every learner.